

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Vijay R

Address: 12 Knockholt Close Sutton Sutton SM2 6ED

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment:Comment

1. Existing Traffic Congestion and Peak-Time Pressure

The proposed site is situated within an area that already experiences significant traffic congestion and pronounced peak-time pressure. The surrounding highway network regularly operates at, or close to, capacity, particularly during school drop-off and pick-up periods. At these times, vehicle queuing, constrained manoeuvring space, and limited visibility are frequent and well-established conditions.

2. Impact of Nearby Primary School

The site lies in close proximity to a primary school with a pupil capacity in excess of 1,000. This results in exceptionally high levels of pedestrian and vehicular movement during the morning and afternoon peak periods. Substantial numbers of children, parents, pushchairs, and cyclists use the adjacent pavements and crossing points, creating a highly sensitive and vulnerable highway environment.

Any further increase in traffic activity in this location would be likely to materially increase risks to child safety and further worsen existing congestion.

3. Cumulative Impact from Recreational and Elderly Facilities

In addition to the school-related traffic, the area is also served by recreational facilities, including tennis courts and a golf facility used by elderly residents. These uses generate ongoing vehicle movements and parking demand throughout the day and into the evening.

The presence of elderly users is a particularly important consideration, as reduced mobility and slower crossing times may increase vulnerability and require enhanced highway safety safeguards.

4. Traffic Generation from Assembly-Based Use

The proposed introduction of a community hall, temple, mosque, church, or other assembly-based use is likely to generate concentrated arrival and departure patterns, particularly during evenings, weekends, and special events.

Unlike residential development, assembly uses typically result in simultaneous peak traffic movements, which can contribute to:

Increased congestion

Greater pressure on on-street parking capacity

Obstructive or unsafe parking behaviour

Reduced visibility at junctions

Restricted access for emergency vehicles

Accordingly, the traffic impacts associated with this form of development would not operate in isolation, but would instead add to and intensify the existing pressures on the local highway network.